



4, Kid Icarus and The Legend of Zelda: A Link Between Worlds also helped bolster the console's lineup. The 3D effect on the device was actually stunning although a few people did complain that the effect was giving them a headache and they couldn't focus on the screen. Sure, the 3D effect was a gimmick but the more I used the console, the more I found myself turning the effect on. I like the idea of a small 3D screen and it really helped in terms of immersion. It also helped that the console was really easy to pick up and play. It was well-designed and controlled incredibly well. The only downside to most Nintendo consoles is its propriety charging port. God help the poor soul who lost his or her charger. The 3DS XL contin-

ued being my daily gaming machine up until the launch of the PS Vita.

The PlayStation Vita was the holy grail for gamers. It followed the same principle as the PSP in that it was an incredibly powerful console that could realistically play PS2 games with no real issues. I saw a friend of mine lug the damn thing around but I finally got the chance to get my hands on the console when one of my nephews got it for his birthday. I had the console for about two months and I finished the portable Uncharted game as well as Ultimate Capcom vs Marvel. The fact that the device wasn't mine means that I wasn't able to mess around with it and turn it into another emulation monster. But at the very least, I got to experience what high-end hand-

held gaming could look like. It wasn't until I got the Nintendo Switch did I truly understand where the medium was headed.

I bought the Switch sometime in 2018 for the sole reason of playing The Legend of Zelda: Breath of the Wild. I have a weak spot for open-world games and from what I'd seen of the game, I already knew that this was my kind of jam. As a handheld for the modern age, the Switch really pushed the limit of what could be achieved on a portable console. Games like the aforementioned BotW, Super Mario Odyssey, Mario Kart 8 and more were some of the best experiences on the Switch. Nintendo hit it out of the park and since its launch in 2017 has outsold both the original Gameboy and even the PS4. Numbers hover around the 122.5 million mark in terms of units sold. That's a lot of consoles! Right now, the Switch is my main gaming console as I tend to play a lot of retro games from Nintendo on the device.

One of the few things I'm actually looking at purchasing next is the Steam Deck. The fact that it costs an arm and a leg in India bums me out. I guess I'll have to contact my relatives abroad about this. It's a real shame that the Deck has not been officially launched in India and even if it was, it's pointless buying the device here since the import taxes will not only burn a hole in your wallet but is absolutely unnecessary. Oh well, here's hoping my cousins heed the call.

The handheld game console is something that I have not been able to shake. I've gone from system to system, finally landing on a combo of a PS5, a gaming PC and the Switch. I honestly think that it's the best way to go since I have access to all three platforms. But, there's just something special about the handheld that has drawn my attention to the platform for the past 30 years. And I seriously suspect that it'll continue for the next 30. *